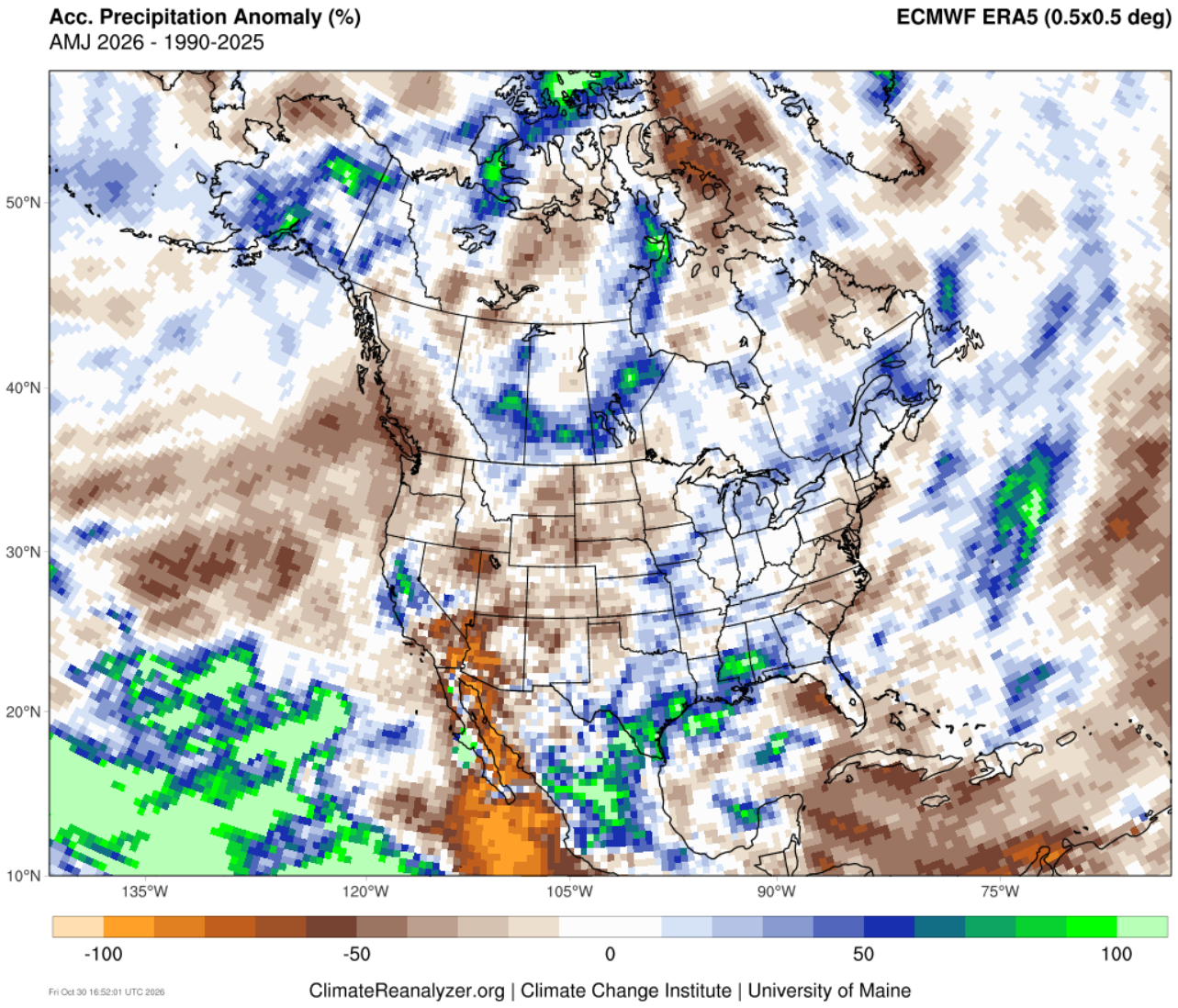
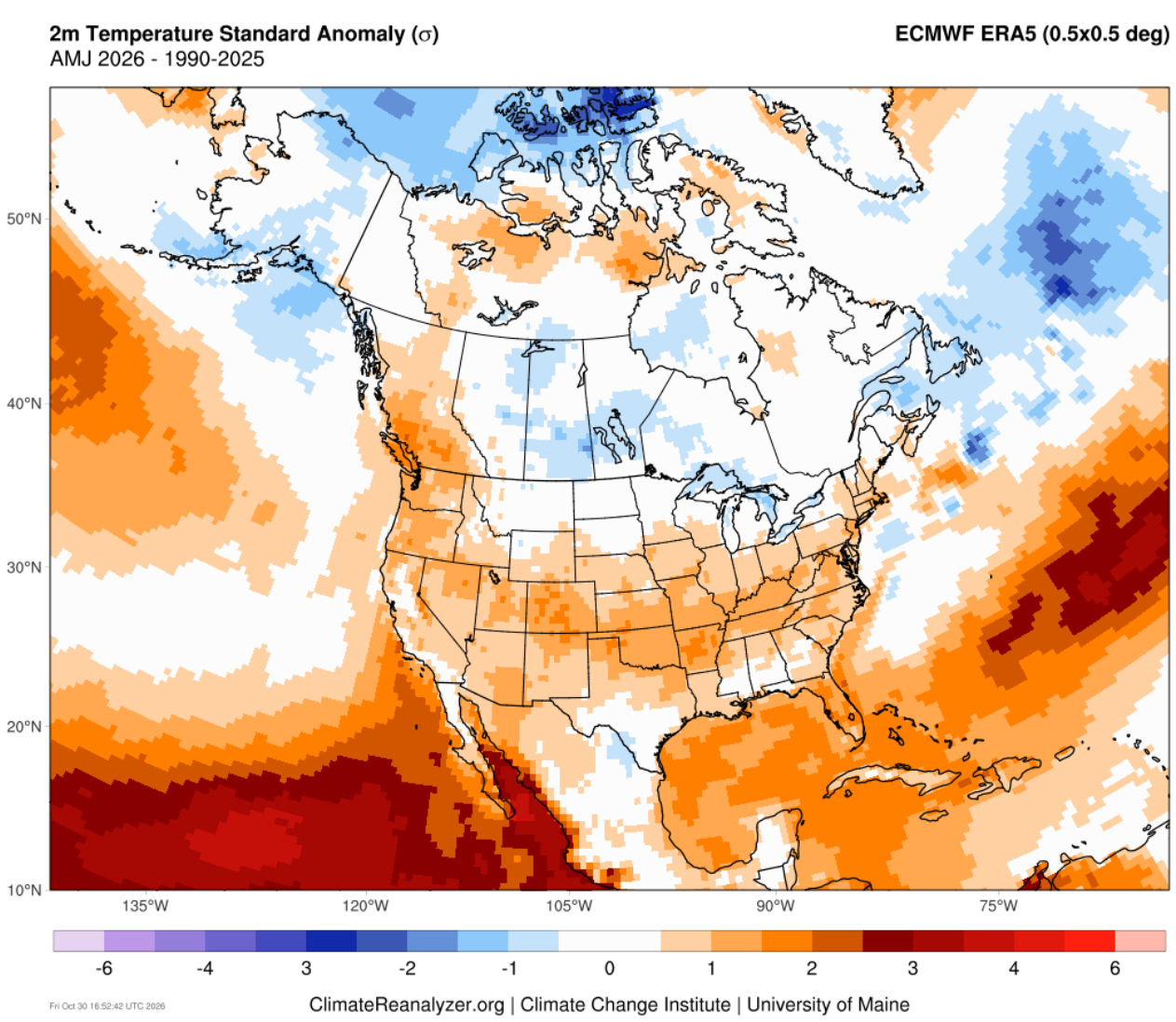
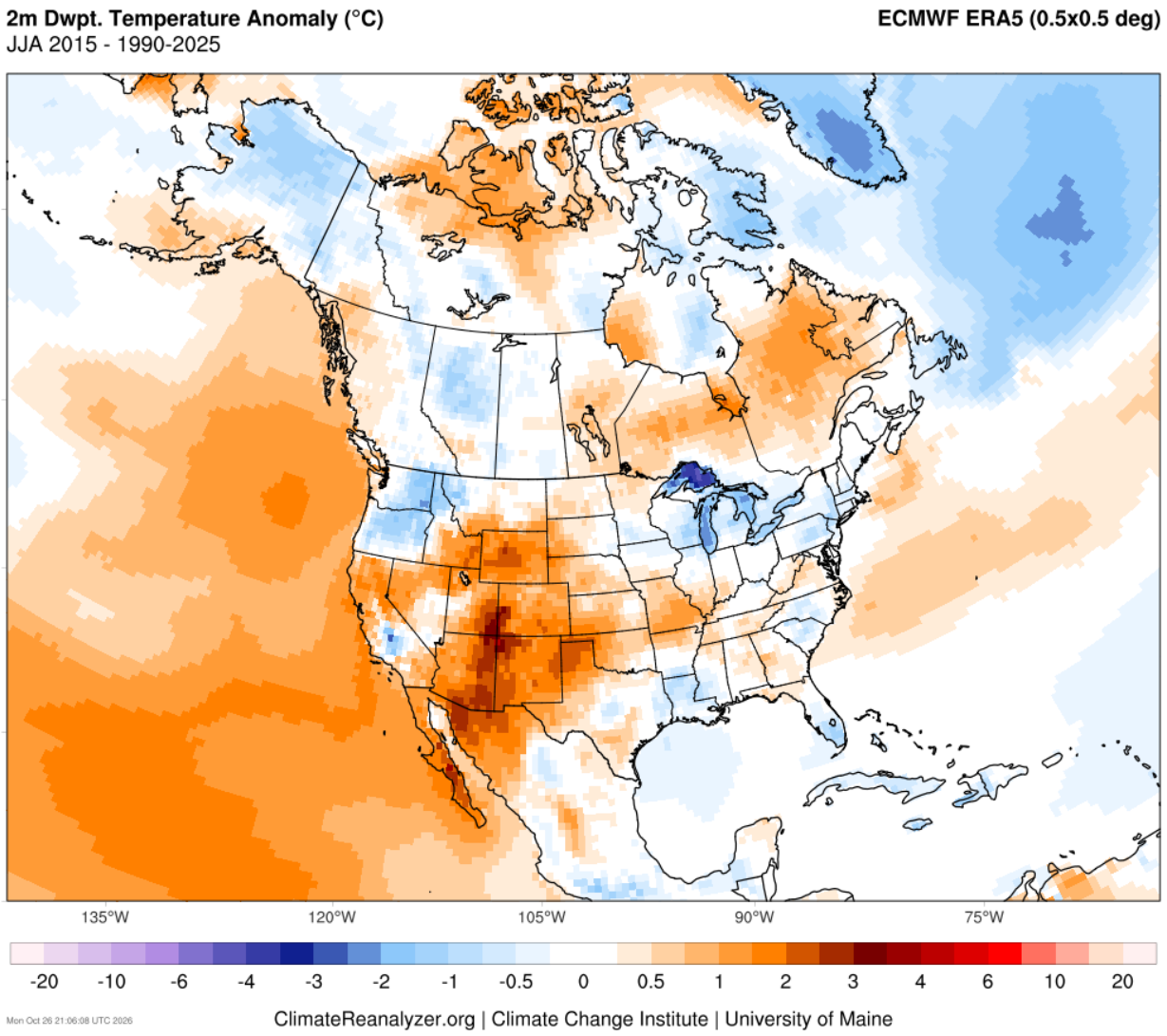
2026 Wildfire Smoke Season Recap

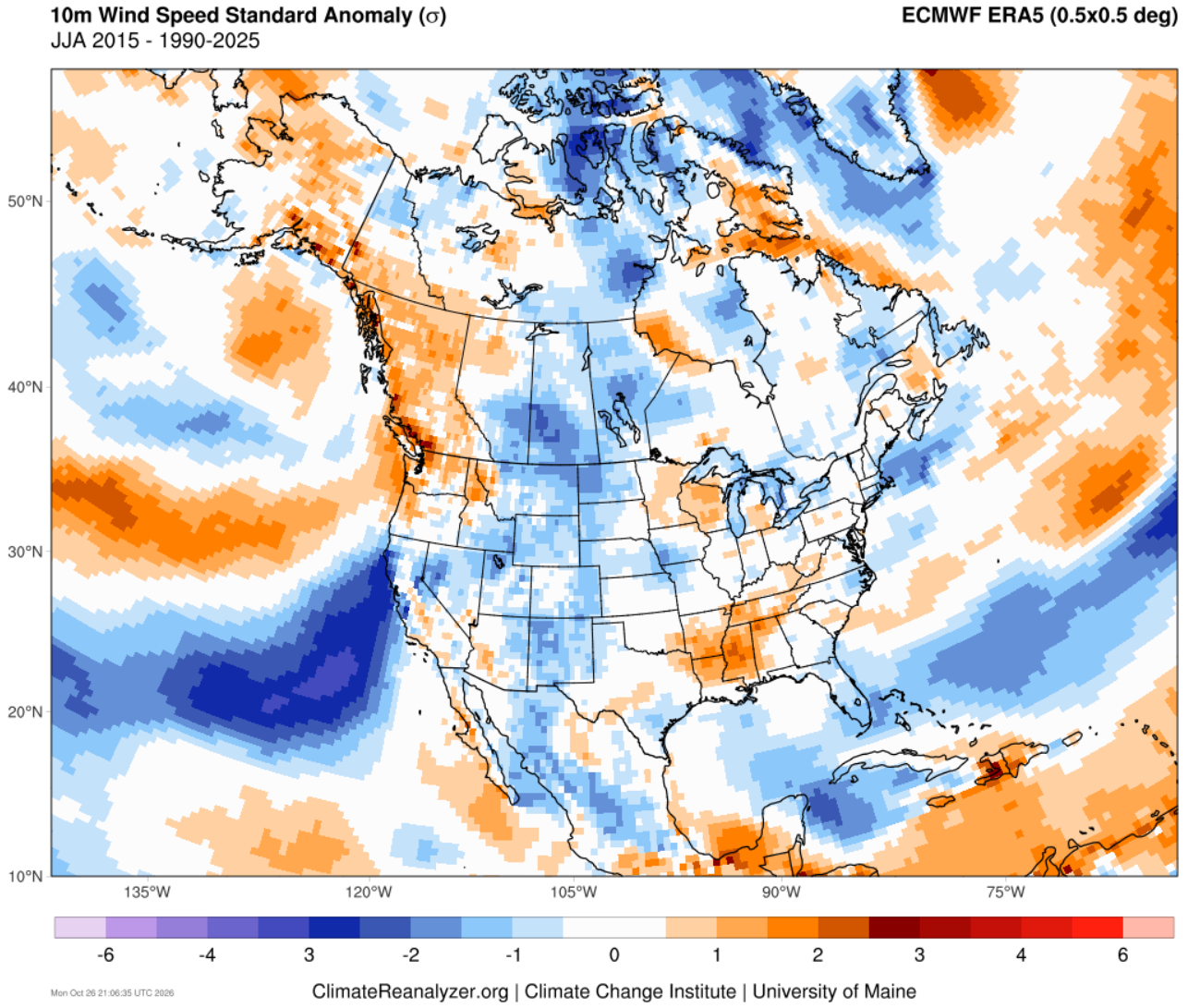
Friday, October 30, 2026

Mason Friedman, Deputy Wildland Fire Meteorologist, WA DNR
mason.friedman@dnr.wa.gov

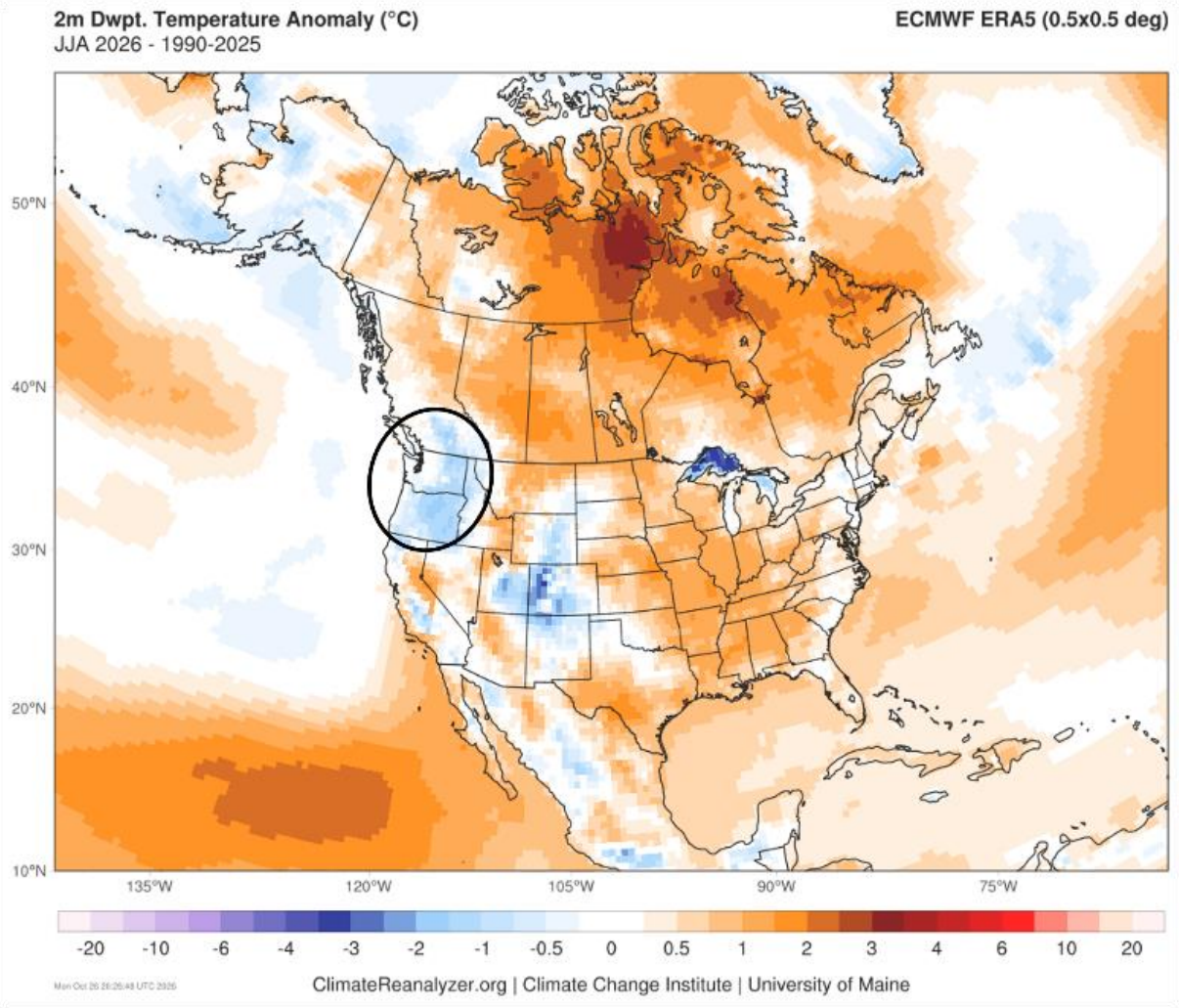

Acc. Precipitation Anomaly (%)
AMJ 2026 - 1990-2025
ECMWF ERA5 (0.5x0.5 deg)
50°N
40°N
30°N
20°N
10°N
135°W
120°W
105°W
90°W
75°W
-100
-50
0
50
100
Fri Oct 30 16:52:01 UTC 2026
ClimateReanalyzer.org | Climate Change Institute | University of Maine

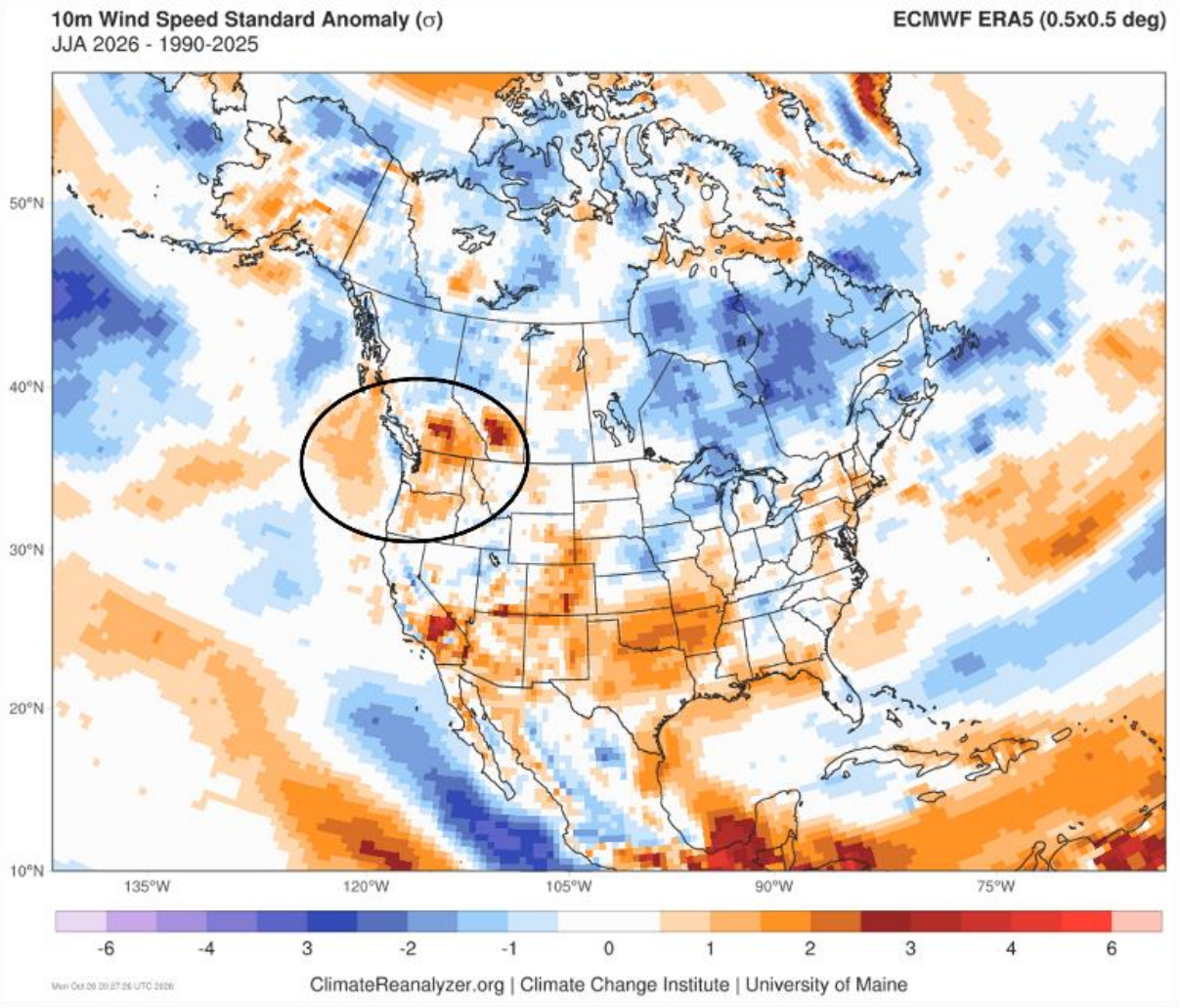

2m Temperature Standard Anomaly (σ)
AMJ 2026 - 1990-2025
ECMWF ERA5 (0.5x0.5 deg)
50°N
40°N
30°N
20°N
10°N
135°W
120°W
105°W
90°W
75°W
-6
-4
3
-2
-1
0
1
2
3
4
6
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ClimateReanalyzer.org | Climate Change Institute | University of Maine

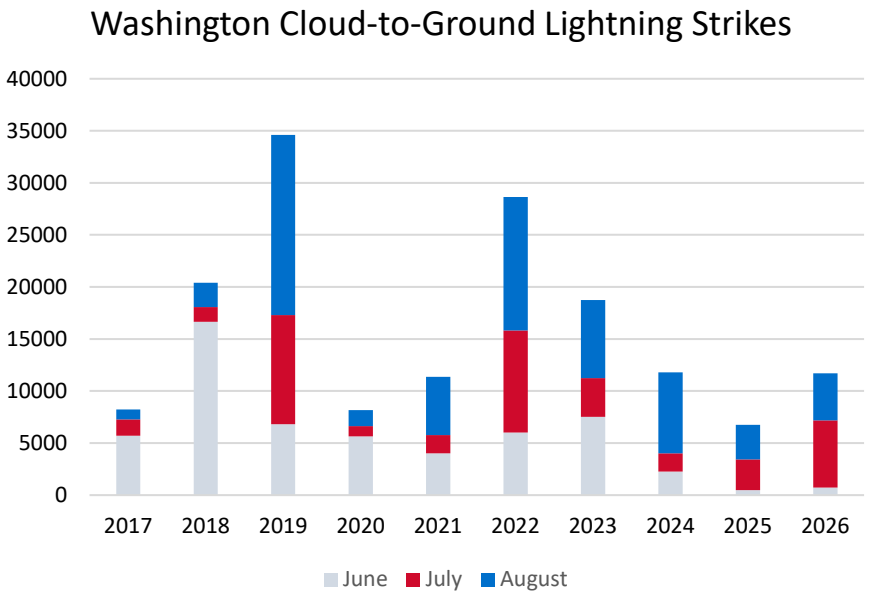

2m Dwpt. Temperature Anomaly (°C)
ECMWF ERA5 (0.5x0.5 deg)
JJA 2015 - 1990-2025
50°N
40°N
30°N
20°N
10°N
135°W
120°W
105°W
90°W
75°W
-20 -10 -6 -4 -3 -2 -1 -0.5 0 0.5 1 2 3 4 6 10 20
Mon Oct 26 21:06:08 UTC 2026
ClimateReanalyzer.org | Climate Change Institute | University of Maine

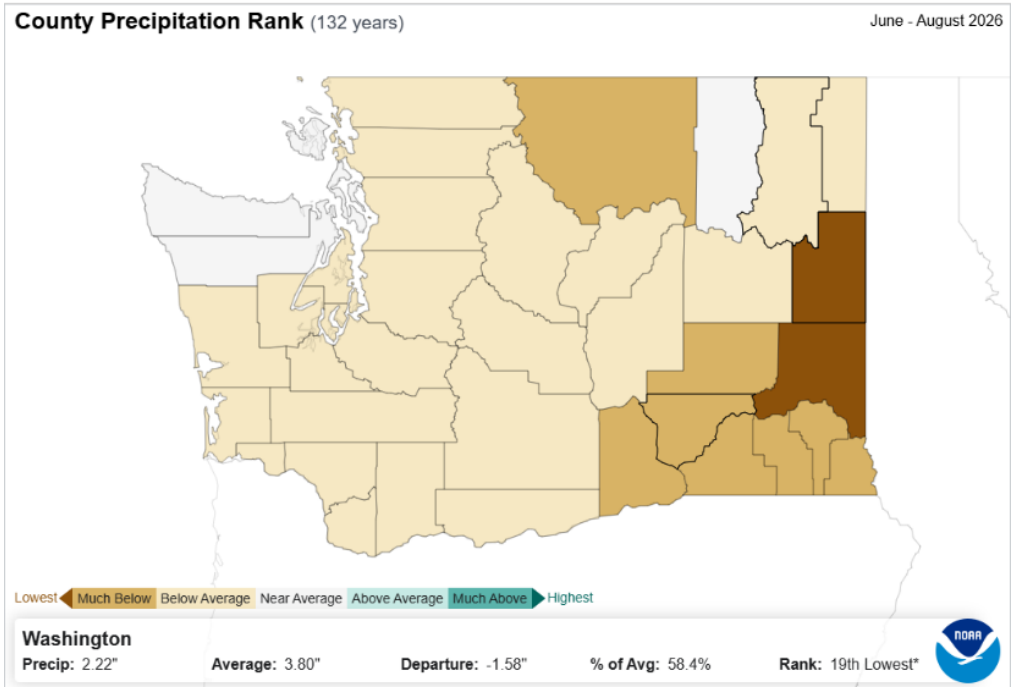

10m Wind Speed Standard Anomaly (σ)
ECMWF ERA5 (0.5x0.5 deg)
JJA 2015 - 1990-2025
50°N
40°N
30°N
20°N
10°N
135°W
120°W
105°W
90°W
75°W
-6 -4 3 -2 -1 0 1 2 3 4 6
Mon Oct 26 21:06:35 UTC 2026
ClimateReanalyzer.org | Climate Change Institute | University of Maine

June-July-August: Surface Dewpoint and Wind Speed Anomaly



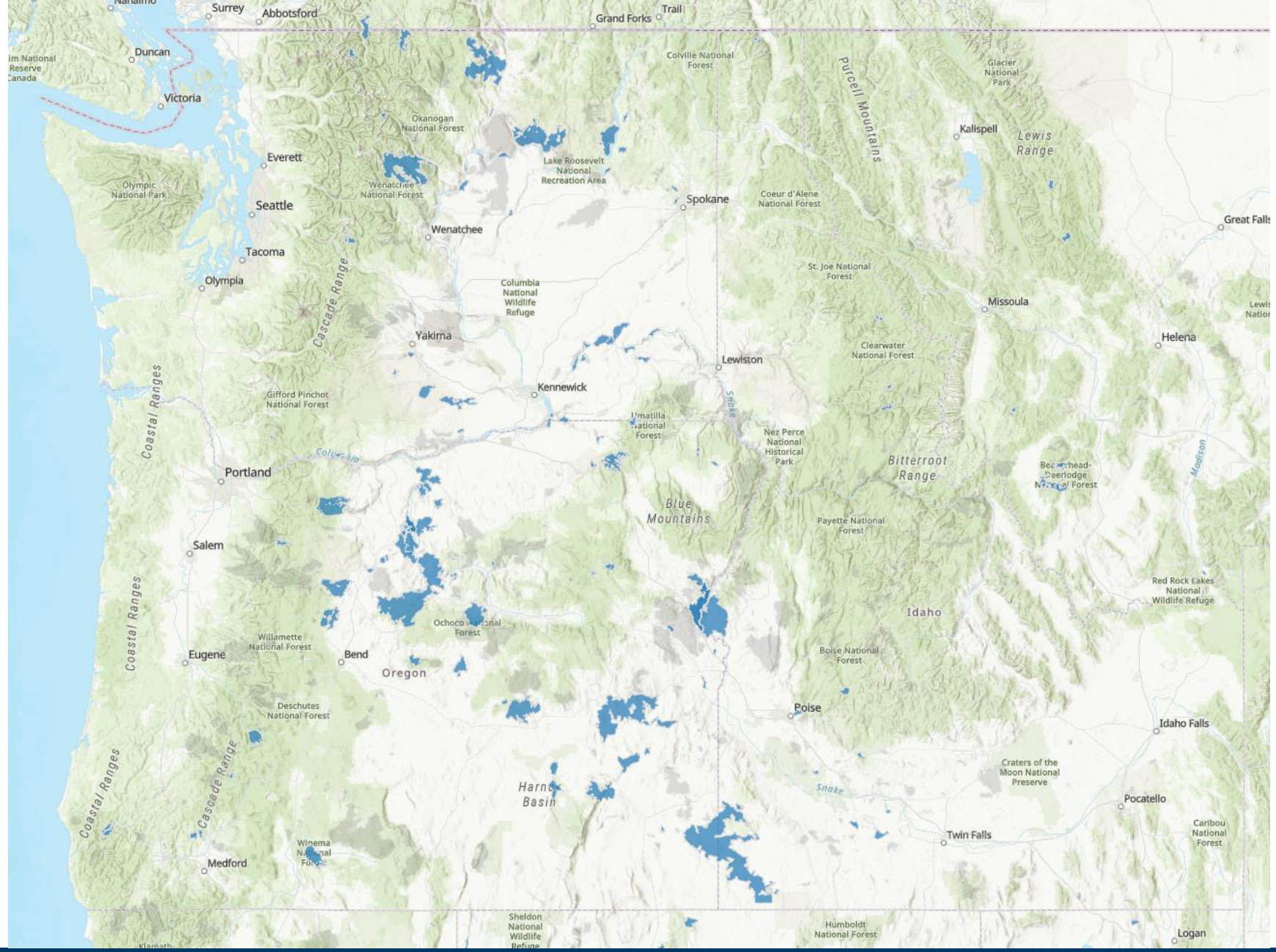



Washington Cloud-to-Ground Lightning Strikes
40000
35000
30000
25000
20000
15000
10000
5000
0
2017
2018
2019
2020
2021
2022
2023
2024
2025
2026
June
July
August

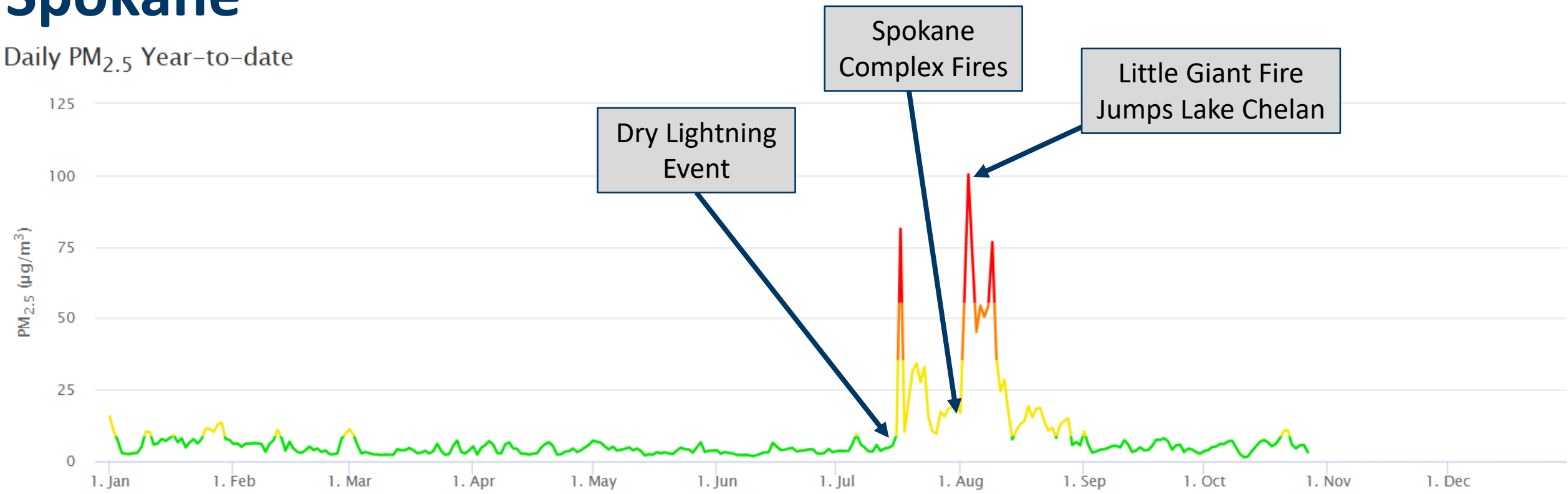

County Precipitation Rank (132 years)
June - August 2026
Lowest
Much Below
Below Average
Near Average
Above Average
Much Above
Highest
Washington
Precip: 2.22"
Average: 3.80"
Departure: -1.58"
% of Avg: 58.4%
Rank: 19th Lowest*

2026 Wildfire Season

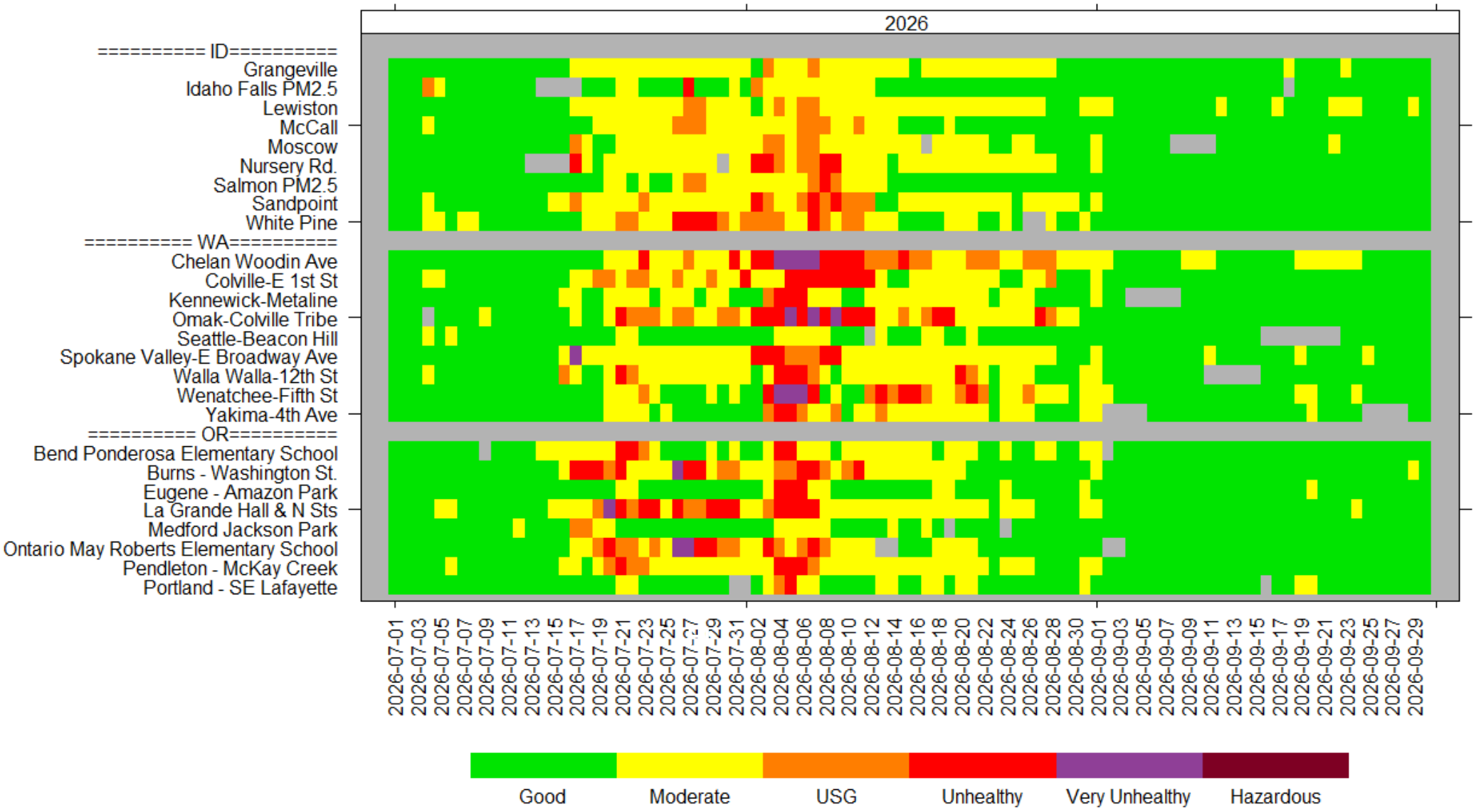
Data: NIFC



Spokane

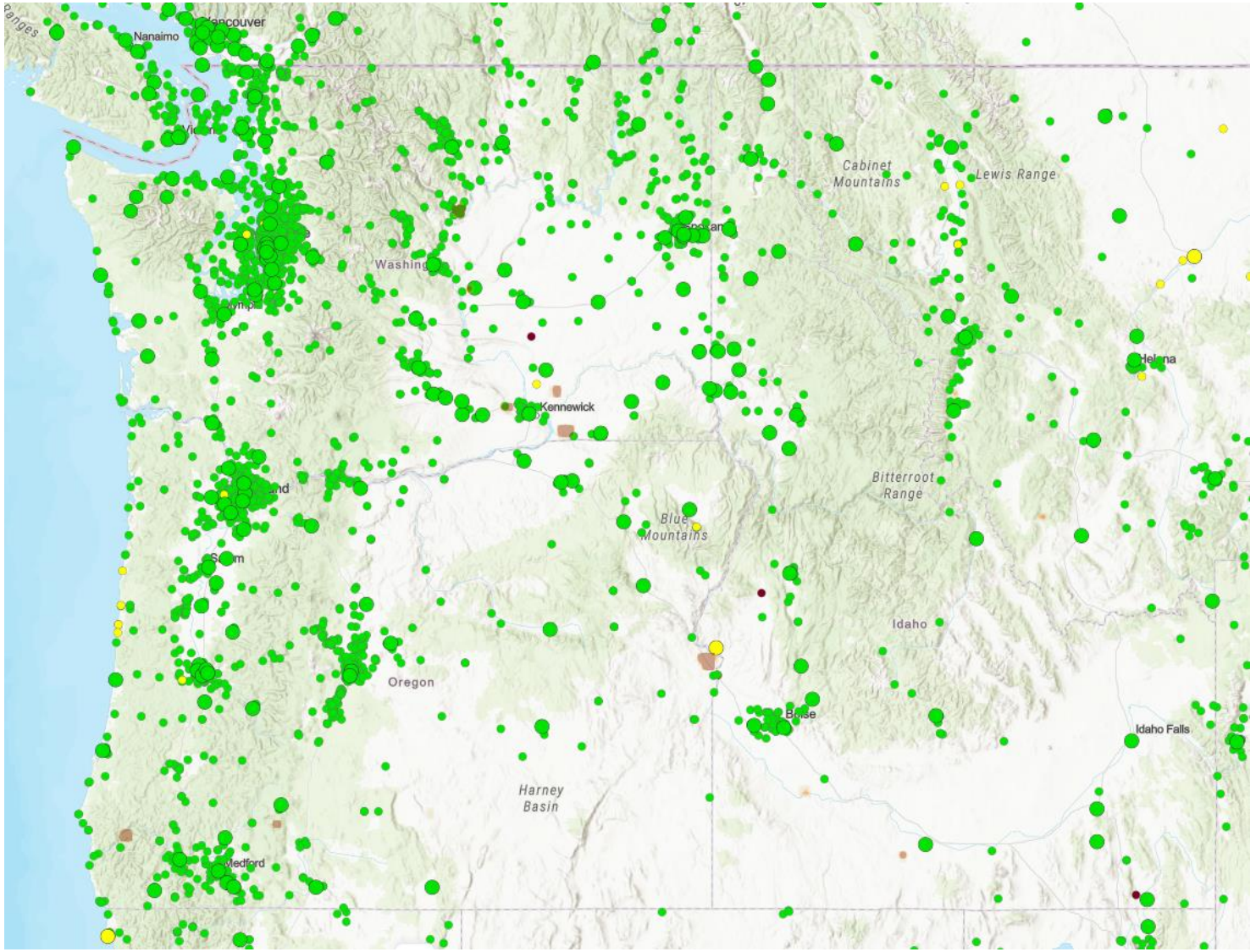

Daily PM2.5 Year-to-date
Spokane Complex Fires
Little Giant Fire Jumps Lake Chelan
Dry Lightning Event
125
100
75
50
25
0
PM2.5 (µg/m3)
1. Jan
1. Feb
1. Mar
1. Apr
1. May
1. Jun
1. Jul
1. Aug
1. Sep
1. Oct
1. Nov
1. Dec

Daily AQI for ID/WA/OR – July/Aug/Sep 2026



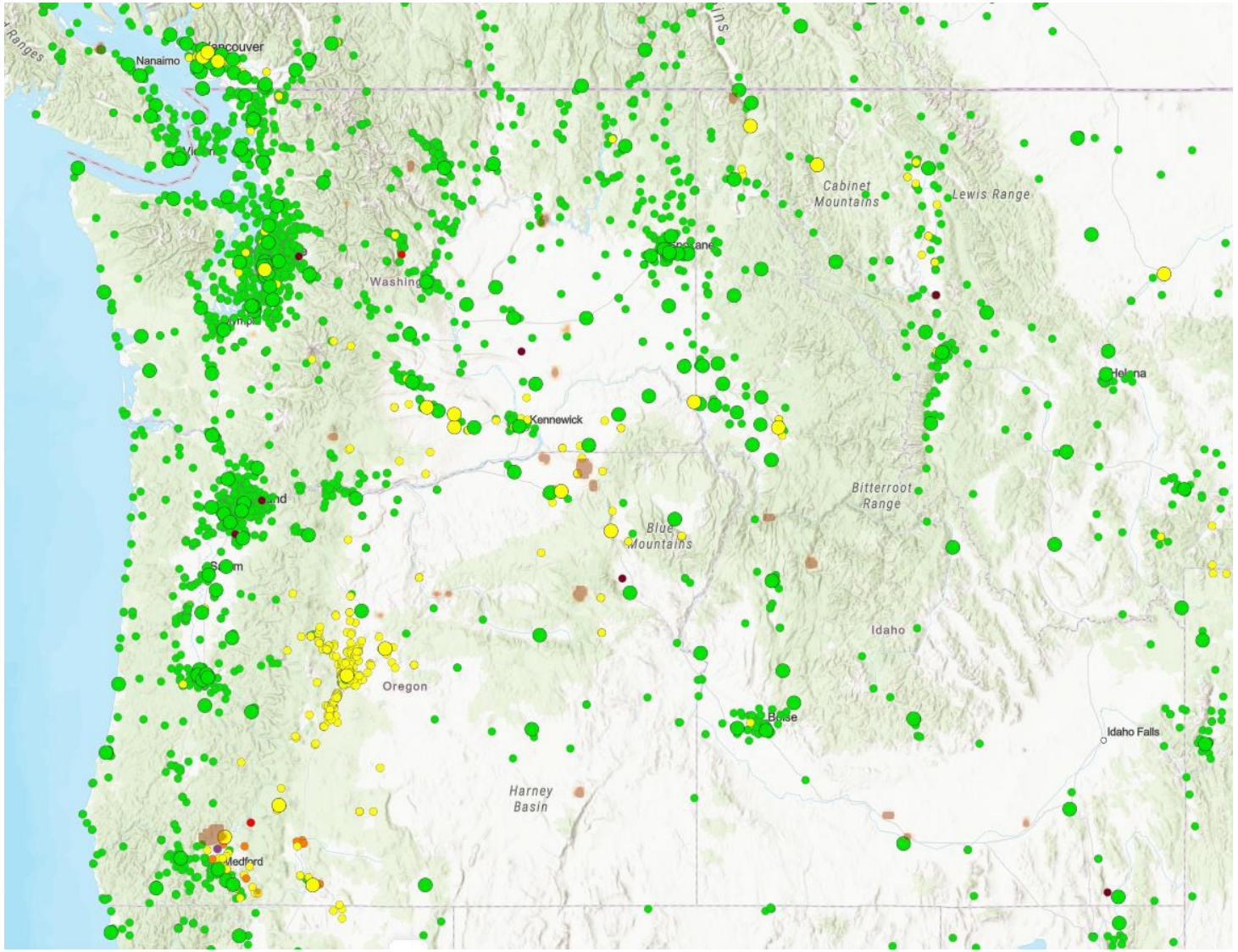
Data via Dept of Ecology

July 1, 2026



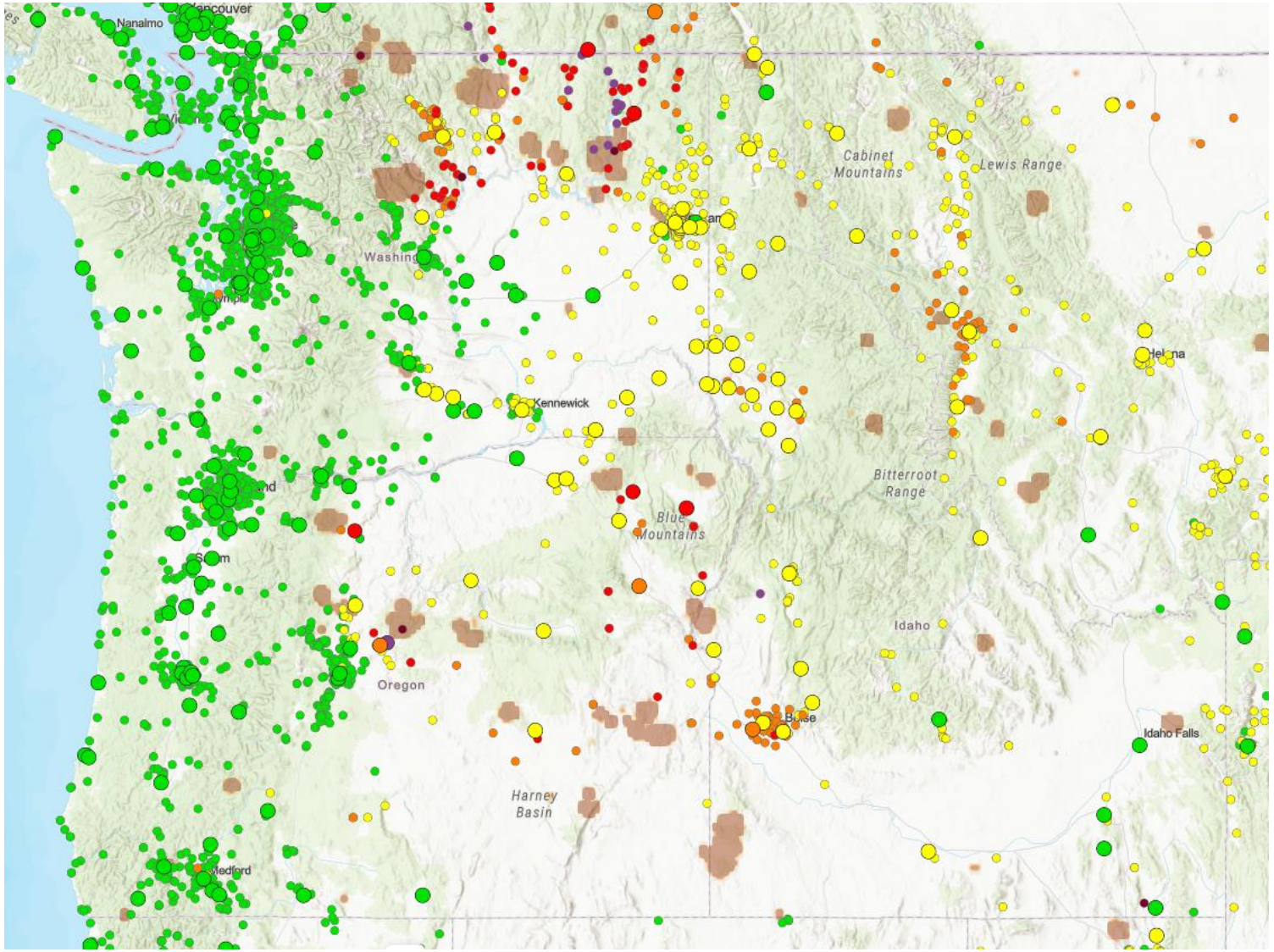
fire.airnow.gov

July 15, 2026



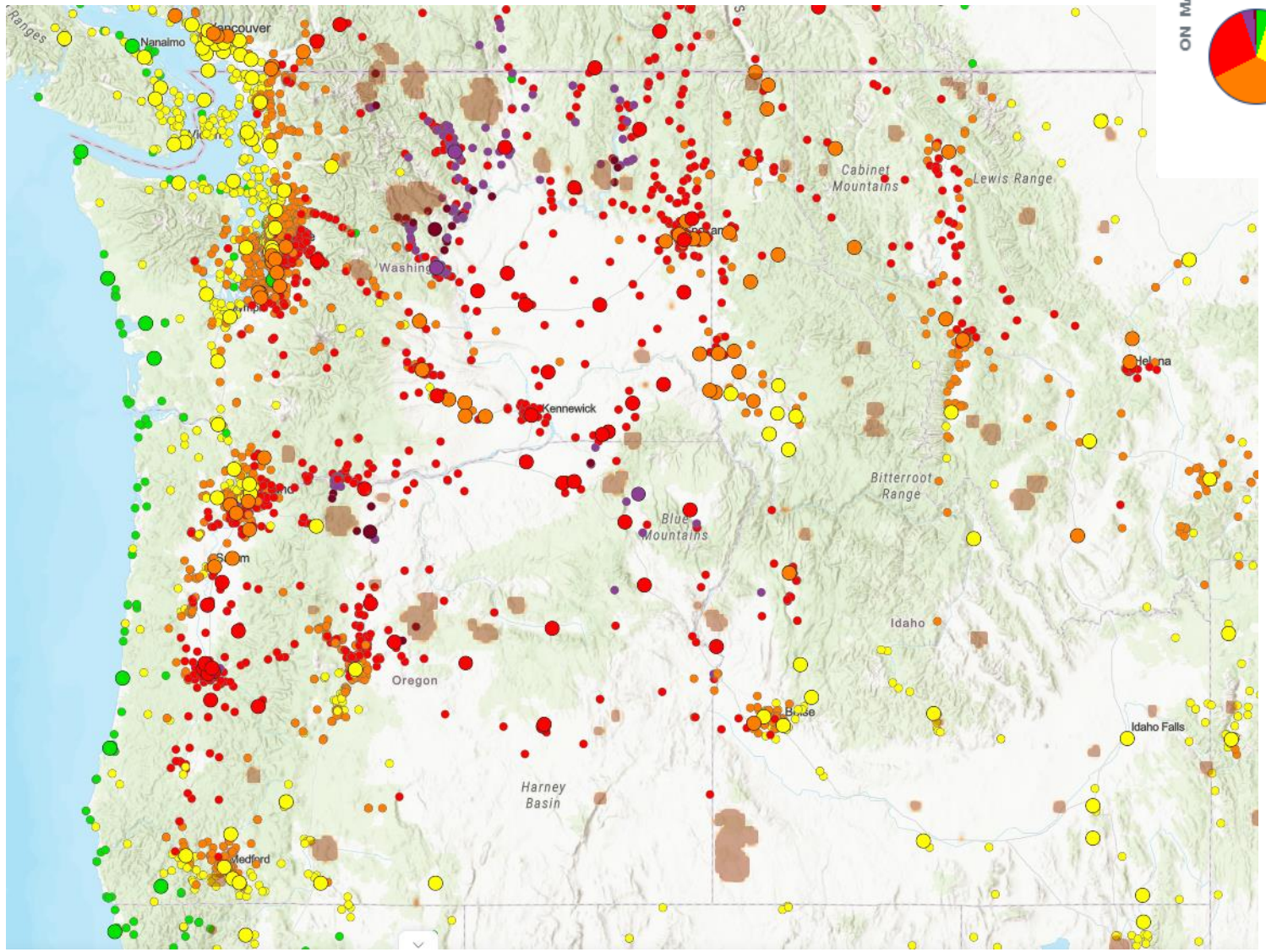
fire.airnow.gov

Aug 1, 2026



fire.airnow.gov

Aug 6, 2026



AQI DEVICES FIRES

ON MAP

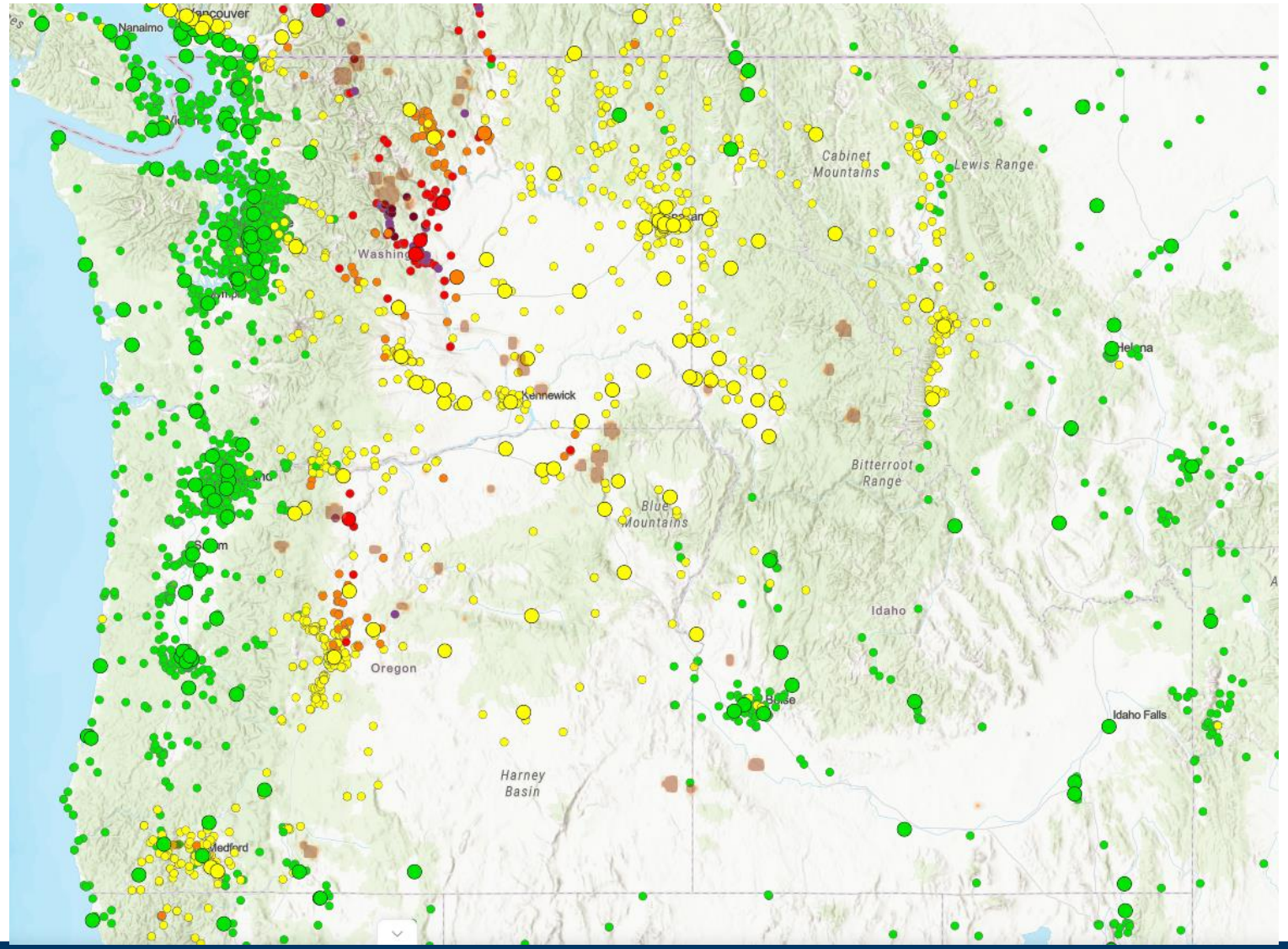
Good	189
Moderate	1030
USG	1345
Unhealthy	1029
Very Unhealthy	161
Hazardous	36

Air Quality Index

- Good (0-50)
- Moderate (51-100)
- Unhealthy for Sensitive Groups (101-150)
- Unhealthy (151-200)
- Very Unhealthy (201-300)
- Hazardous (301+)

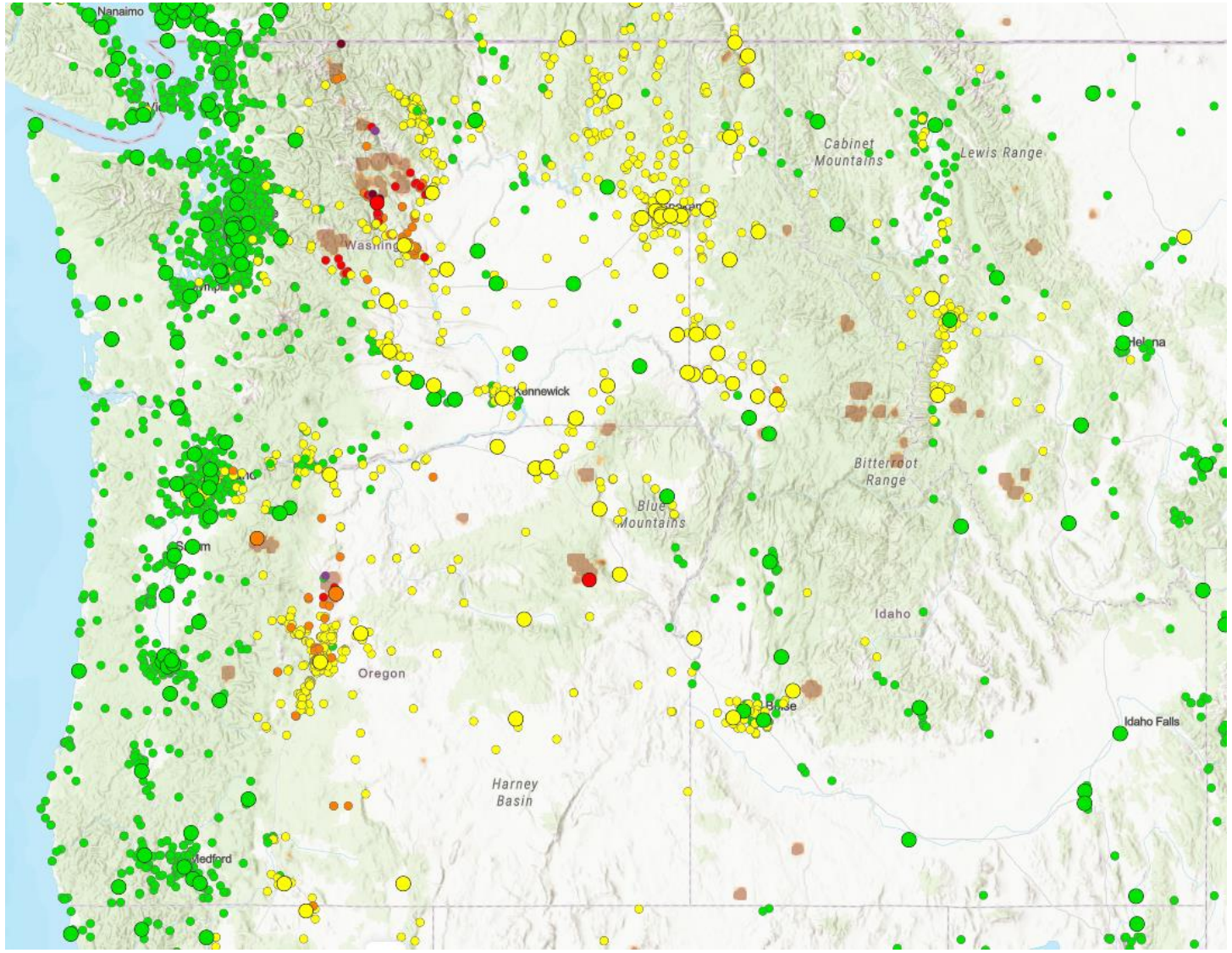
fire.airnow.gov

Aug 15, 2026



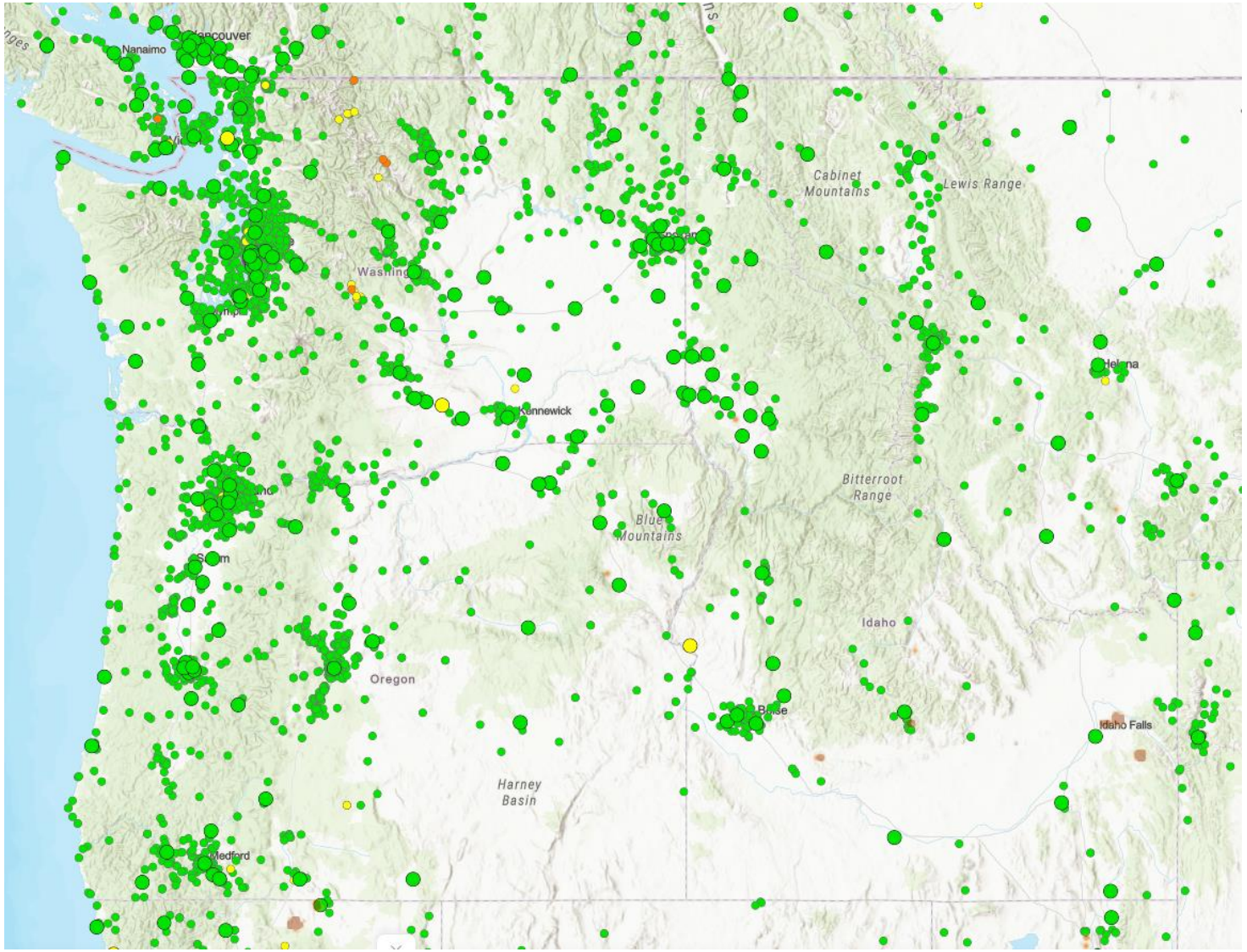
fire.airnow.gov

Sep 1, 2026



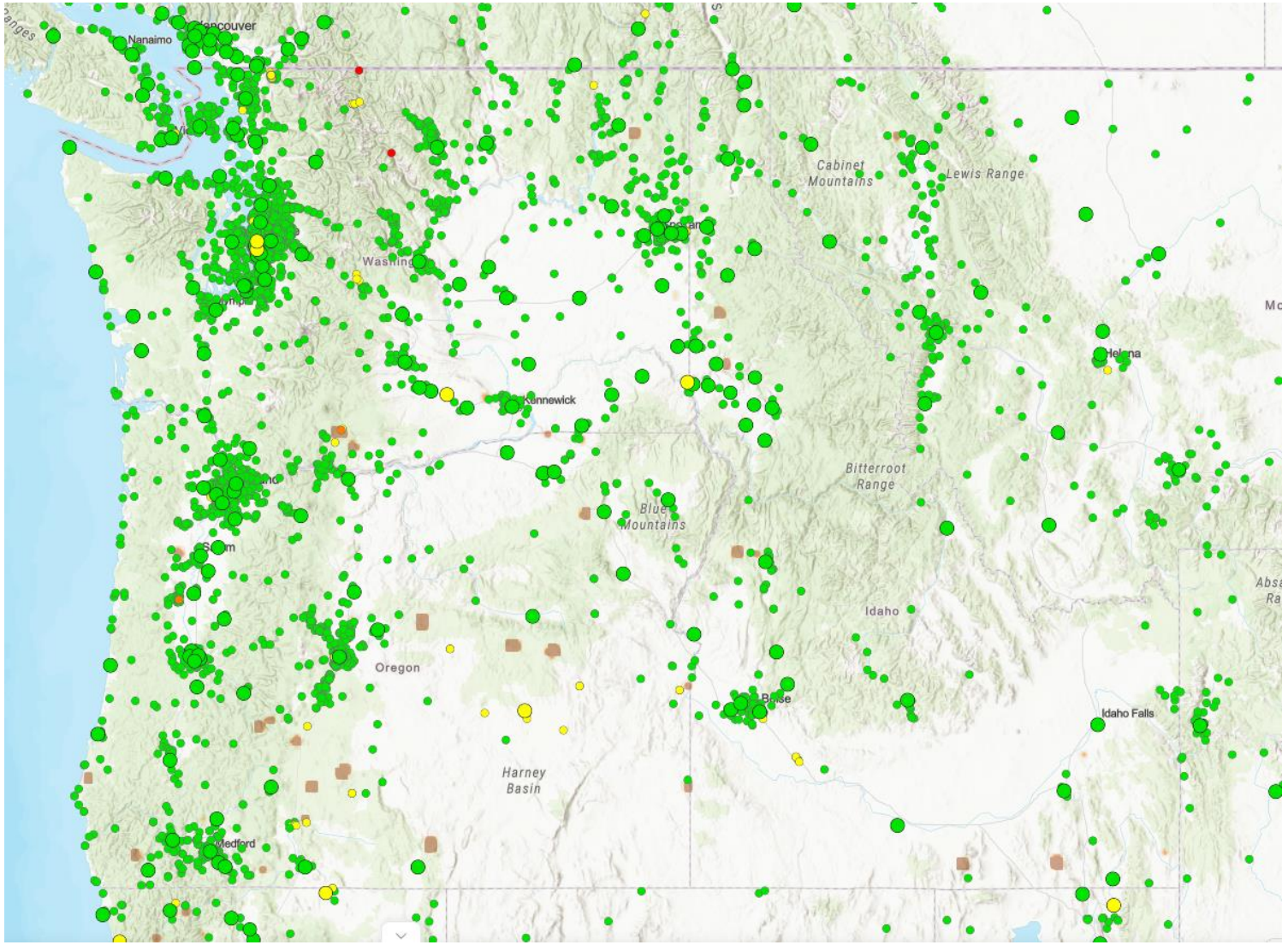
fire.airnow.gov

Sep 15, 2026



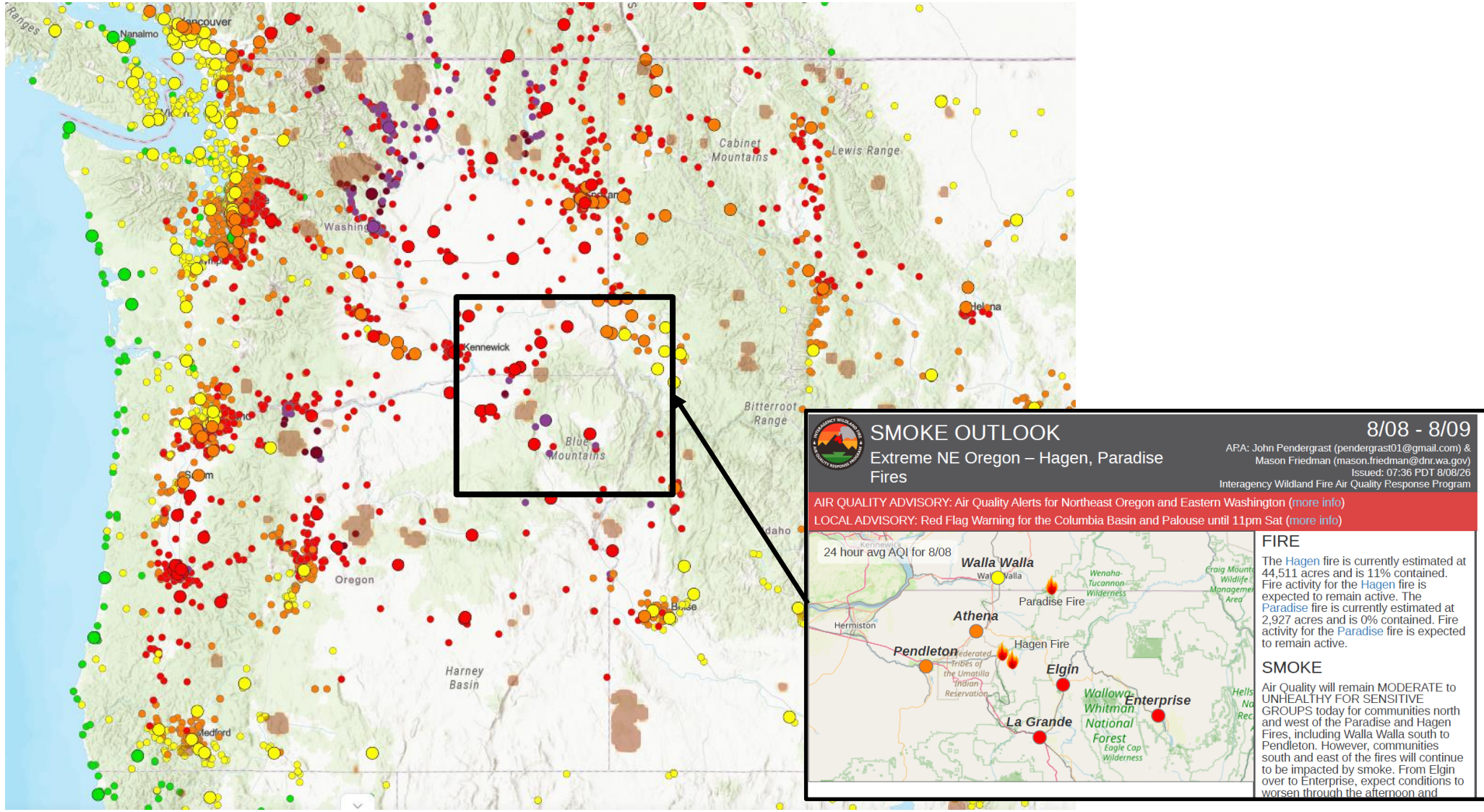
fire.airnow.gov

Oct 1, 2026



fire.airnow.gov

Aug 6, 2026


Nanaimo
Kennewick
Cabinet Mountains
Lewis Range
Bitterroot Range
Blue Mountains
Oregon
Harney Basin
SMOKE OUTLOOK
Extreme NE Oregon – Hagen, Paradise Fires
8/08 - 8/09
AIR QUALITY ADVISORY: Air Quality Alerts for Northeast Oregon and Eastern Washington (more info)
LOCAL ADVISORY: Red Flag Warning for the Columbia Basin and Palouse until 11pm Sat (more info)
24 hour avg AQI for 8/08
Walla Walla
Paradise Fire
Athena
Hermiston
Hagen Fire
Pendleton
Elgin
Wallowa-Whitman National Forest
Enterprise
La Grande
FIRE
The Hagen fire is currently estimated at 44,511 acres and is 11% contained. Fire activity for the Hagen fire is expected to remain active. The Paradise fire is currently estimated at 2,927 acres and is 0% contained. Fire activity for the Paradise fire is expected to remain active.
SMOKE
Air Quality will remain MODERATE to UNHEALTHY FOR SENSITIVE GROUPS today for communities north and west of the Paradise and Hagen Fires, including Walla Walla south to Pendleton. However, communities south and east of the fires will continue to be impacted by smoke. From Elgin over to Enterprise, expect conditions to worsen through the afternoon and





Smoke Forecaster Perspectives



- Models such as HRRR smoke are useful for large scale smoke movement, understanding potential trends relative to current air quality – if used cautiously

- Weather and fire behavior drive smoke production, also operational decisions such as large-scale burn operations – opportunity to feed intel from wildfire teams into regional smoke models like AIRPACT?

- Smoke feedback effects -- thick smoke can block solar radiation, reducing temperature, reducing fire behavior, reducing smoke production. Also making it more difficult for inversions to lift and smoke to clear. Models struggle with these feedbacks and interactions.

- Models also struggle with boundary layer in general, poor performance with inversions and smoke pooling in complex terrain

- Smoke ‘fronts’ can develop with large fire plumes, poorly modeled

Superposition of Smoke-Induced Density Currents and Diurnal Wind Systems During the California Mosquito Fire

Joseph F. Marino[1] and Neil P. Lareau[1]

[1]Department of Physics, University of Nevada Reno, Reno, NV, USA

